



MONTHLY UPDATE

Access to services: monthly update, July 2026

Edition of 2026-08-16 · compiled from the Data Landscapers source base

30 places. Every block below is carried verbatim from that place's own monthly update, where it was written, sourced and checked; nothing is written here.

Angola

Financial inclusion was scored at [51.7% for the first quarter of 2026 against a 65% target for 2027](#) on 9 July, with banking at about 32% or 5.7 million people and mobile and digital payments up about 56% year on year; the strategy document itself is not held.

Burkina Faso

A financial inclusion agency delivered training and consumer protection this month, not its regulator.

Burundi

ABUCO's [statement of 28 July 2026](#) is the month's one dated position on affordability: internet package tariffs have more than doubled since the January 2025 instruction to operators to improve service, while quality fell, and it runs against the service obligations that instruction set. Its president describes the sector as having returned to the situation of the early 2000s and names businesses, traders and public administrations among those affected. The two sources on file attribute that instruction differently, one to the telecommunications ministry and one to the interior minister; no text of it is held.

Cote d'Ivoire

A guarantee arrangement was the month's only committed money in this section. Two conventions signed on 23 July mobilise [up to FCFA 17bn across two windows](#) for small and medium enterprises, with stated attention to women's entrepreneurship; it is an envelope rather than a committed sum.

DR Congo

On 23 July a state bank and the payroll monitoring committee settled the technical and organisational terms for [paying civil servants in rural territories, scoped to three named territories and others where no other bank operates](#). August 2026 was named as a target, with the bank's director-general calling a fixed date premature and the state contract unsigned.

Egypt

The month's clearest inclusion move was a reopening rather than an extension. From 24 July the state accepted ration-card grievance and data-update forms at 500 post offices on Friday afternoons and Saturday mornings, alongside the online route that had until then been the only channel for appeals against the 2026 eligibility criteria, with a daily adjudication committee, results notified by text message and every case checked against official databases.

Ethiopia

The same coverage recorded the device side: bank financing deals targeting up to two million smartphones a year to low-income citizens on instalment plans.

Gabon

On 29 July the social affairs ministry presented the first deliverable of the unified social register at Libreville, with World Bank representatives present, alongside a stated commitment to full digitalisation of non-contributory social protection under the 2026-2030 development plan ([presentation](#)). No beneficiary count, coverage figure or platform was given, and the state's own account uses three different names for the register in the same document.

Ghana

The mid-year fiscal review of 23 July recorded GH¢485m paid to cash-grant beneficiaries in the first half of 2026 and named no allocation at all to the communications ministry, the access fund, the coders programme or the artificial-intelligence strategy.

Kenya

The Auditor-General's findings on the Hustler Fund entered the record on 23 July: [104,631 loans worth KSh 116.5m](#) were issued to borrowers whose national identity details were missing from the customer database, against a 15% default rate and state funding down to KSh 300m in the year to June 2026.

Lesotho

At Geneva on 9 July the ministry gave its own measure of the access problem — [100% broadband coverage against about 50% regular internet use](#), which it attributed to affordability.

Liberia

No later figure for account ownership or mobile wallet holding has been published. The base's position rests on the [account of digital finance expansion of 13 July](#), which carries no measurement of its own.

Libya

On 5 August a Central Bank source told Libya Herald that cash distribution to commercial bank branches would begin on 9 August under an August operational plan, with [withdrawal limits starting at LD 3,000 per customer and LD 4,000 in the south](#), subject to increase as liquidity allows.

Madagascar

The month's only market measurement came from an operator: MVola's director general put the whole Malagasy mobile-money market at [six to seven million active users against a population of about thirty million, with rural areas under-served](#), and set doubling or tripling that as the five-to-ten-year test.

Morocco

An operator's sustainability report published on 10 July recorded 6,000 internet boxes refurbished in Morocco during 2025, which the operator put at about EUR 1.5m in savings, within a regional programme that refurbished 164,000 boxes in 2025, up 43% on 2024 ([operator report](#)). The figures are the operator's own and unaudited in the held source.

Mozambique

The central bank's Financial Inclusion Report 2025, reported on 24 July, counted 482,359 financial access points, up 36% on 2024, of which 446,604 were non-bank agents against 315,005 the year before, while automated teller machines fell from 1,391 to 1,383 and card terminals from 35,486 to 32,236 ([report account](#)). [Mobile money reached 1,313 accounts per thousand adults against 337 bank accounts](#), and the national Financial Inclusion Index held flat at 36.4 points. Agent growth was fastest in the least-served provinces, and the report set that against a widening credit gap: women's participation in credit rose from 31% to 34% while men's rose from 59% to 66%, even as women's mobile money holding rose 24%.

Namibia

The central bank's deputy governor told the payments association's annual general meeting on 28 July that financial inclusion rose from 78% in 2017 to 86% in 2025, and named continued cash reliance, limited rural access, informal-sector barriers and the digital divide as the persistent constraints ([central bank account](#)).

Niger

On 15 July the World Food Programme [inaugurated the Guidan Fasaha community digital centre at Tahoua](#), the second such centre after Diffa, with 100 computers and 50 kW of solar power, funded by Luxembourg and aimed at young people, women and displaced people.

Nigeria

An [agent-network microfinance operator founded in 2018 was profiled during the month](#), reaching microenterprises and the historically unbanked through trained local agents with naira-denominated formalisation and credit rather than dollar substitution; no user, loan-book or coverage figures are published.

A [digital self-care platform went live for University of Lagos students](#), routing to free contraceptives through the state health ministry and UNFPA supply chain, with expansion to other Lagos campuses planned.

Rwanda

Formal financial access was reported at [96% of adults in 2024 against 48% in 2008](#), with 68.5% using a mobile wallet and only about 5% holding a bank account. Against that headline, the agent network contracted at the second operator over the year to March 2026, and the accounts-per-agent ratio widened. The legacy-network retirement plan carries handset-affordability measures, which is the inclusion question the 30 June 2027 deadline turns on: the single figure that would show whether the deadline is achievable — the share of the handset base capable of voice over fourth-generation networks — has not been published by the operator, the ministry or the regulator. [Nothing was published in the month on school connectivity, which stands at 4,184 of 4,996 schools connected as at March 2026, leaving 812 mostly rural against a government target of 80%.](#)

Senegal

An [advanced-level digital course for blind and partially sighted people opened on 6 July](#), on a programme reporting 700 people and twenty trainers trained since its launch. The launch date is not stated, so the cumulative figure has no start point.

Sierra Leone

Financial inclusion is put at [about 40% of adults for 2025](#). It is a named analyst's assessment rather than an official series, and the base holds no state measurement to set beside it.

South Africa

The South African Social Security Agency [set 350,000 grant reviews for 2026/27](#) against a projected R1.5bn saving, while beneficiaries flagged from September 2025 [reported continued non-payment](#). An account of the digitalised grants system published on 25 July set out the [bank-account means test applied across eight grants](#), which remains in operation under appeal, with the Supreme Court of Appeal hearing set for 25 August 2026. Gold Cards were confirmed to [cease functioning after 31 August](#); the position of beneficiaries who miss the deadline was not stated.

South Sudan

The cost of connection rose for the second time in two months when the [second phase of the tariff exchange-rate adjustment took effect on 26 July 2026](#), with no revised rates published by the regulator or the operators. Against a baseline of [about US\\$23.70 per gigabyte in November 2025](#), there is now no published price for mobile data in the country.

Tanzania

Financial access points reached [2.27m, up 33.5%, of which about 2m are mobile-money agents](#) at end-December 2025 — growth that is agent build-out rather than branch build-out, as the council itself says.

Togo

An operator [added three mobile-money services](#) — insurance premium payment, withdrawal-card transfer, and gift cards for international streaming and gaming platforms. The account is the operator's own.

Tunisia

On the cost side, the regulator [reported on 18 July 2026](#) that Tunisia's digital basket costs 1.53% of gross national income per head, about US\$5.31 a month — second in the Maghreb and under the two-percent international threshold. The figures are the international union's, cited rather than absorbed as country state.

Uganda

At a readiness inspection on 27 July, [six of nineteen planned one-stop service centres were recorded as operational](#), with three pilots funded through the Uganda Digital Acceleration Project and centre throughput made contingent on the fifth phase of the national backbone.

An [ICT hub for persons with disabilities was commissioned in Kasese](#), reported on 1 August, offering computer literacy, vocational skills and digital-empowerment programmes and open to the wider community. No commitment value was published, so the base carries no finance record for it.

Zambia

The same 27 July account puts financial inclusion at 80.1% of adults in 2025, with mobile money use at 76.2% ([switch account](#)).

Zimbabwe

The health minister told the National Assembly on 17 July that more than 400 health facilities had received satellite kits with 300 more to be added, but that subscriptions had not been paid because the fees were too high ([National Assembly account](#)).

At a payments conference on 24 July a research firm reported that 95% of transport payments remain cash, that 56% of respondents found digital systems complicated with people with disabilities particularly affected ([conference account](#)).

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